Athlete and Sports Participation: Gender Parity & Discipline Trajectories

Phase 5: Demographic & Gender Dynamics

Project: Global Olympic Sports Performance Analysis • **Author:** Md. Firdous Alam • **Era:** 1896–2016 Centennial Dataset

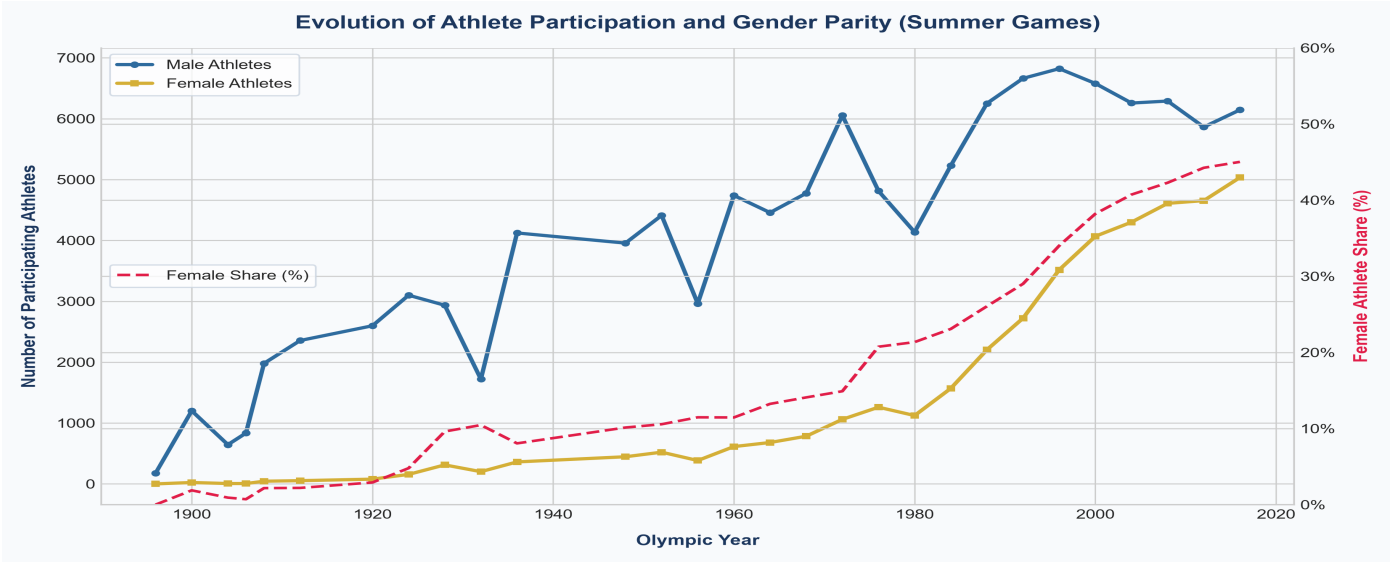


Figure: Centennial Growth of Female Olympic Athlete Representation (1900 to 2016)

1. The Century-Long Journey to Gender Parity

One of the most profound transformations in Olympic history is the rise of female athletic participation. From near total exclusion in 1896 to 45.0% of all competitors in Rio 2016, women's sports have achieved unprecedented global stature.